INCOMPLETE: page fetching was blocked for every host tried, so every finding below rests on search-engine extracts of the named pages, not on full reads. No quote could be verified. A gap-fill pass (2026-11-06, 30 searches) added: the technical shared-context problem (enterprise text-to-SQL and RAG benchmarks, agent memory, MCP adoption and documented MCP and Copilot security incidents), bank and retailer deployments (JPMorgan, Goldman, Bank of America, Walmart), security-review delay surveys, and controlled ROI evidence (two field experiments, UK and Australian government Copilot evaluations, Forrester TEI as vendor-commissioned). STILL MISSING: a primary source for semantic or context layers improving agent accuracy in production; any audited bank or retailer ROI figure (all figures are company-reported, several via blogs); procurement timelines from pilot to signed contract (only security-review delay data found); a census of production agent incidents and post-mortems beyond the four security disclosures below; Salesforce FY27 quarters.

Track 3: Enterprise

Last updated: 2026-11-06. Labels: EVIDENCE = measured/primary data; FORECAST = projection; OPINION = argument, vendor or consultancy view.

Verification note (added 2026-11-06): page fetches were blocked for most hosts this session, so findings marked search summary, search extract or snippet rest on search-engine extracts of the cited URL. Quotation marks inside findings mark wording as reported by that source; only quotes in this file's "Verbatim quotes" section (and in 13-quotes.md) were checked against a fetched page. Corrections from the verification pass are in verification.md.

Summary

- **There is no single "share of pilots reaching production" figure.** The widely cited numbers range from 5% to about 46%. They measure different things: organisations or projects, "reached production" or "showed P&L impact", custom tools or any GenAI. They come from different samples, most of them vendor-sponsored or self-selected. Stacking them as if they agree ("88 to 95% of pilots fail") is a category error.
- **The MIT NANDA "95%" figure is weak.** It comes from a self-described preliminary report built on 52 interviews, 153 survey responses and a review of about 300 public initiatives. It counts success only as measurable P&L impact from embedded or task-specific GenAI tools within roughly six months. The 5% applies to organisations getting custom enterprise tools into production with P&L impact. It does not measure "AI pilots" in general.
- **The Gartner figures are forecasts, not measurements.** "30% of GenAI projects abandoned after PoC by end of 2025" (July 2024) and ">40% of agentic AI projects cancelled by end of 2027" (June 2025) are routinely quoted as findings. The agentic forecast sits on a January 2025 poll of 3,412 webinar attendees. The press release does not say how the "only about 130 real agentic vendors" estimate was produced.
- **The IDC/Lenovo "88% of POCs don't reach production" (4 in 33) was contradicted a year later by the same sponsor-and-research-firm pair.** The Lenovo CIO Playbook 2026, with IDC fieldwork in September and October 2025 and n=3,120, says 46% of AI POCs have progressed into production. It is unclear whether the jump is real, a change of question, or a change of sample.
- **The stated causes of failure only partly support the thesis.** IDC blames organisational readiness (data, processes, IT infrastructure). RAND's interviews put "stakeholders misunderstand what problem needs solving" first. Gartner and S&P Global, however, put cost,

unclear business value, risk controls, data privacy and security at the top. Those are economic and risk-governance problems, not workforce resistance.

- **Adoption keeps rising but profit impact is flat.** McKinsey's 2025 survey (n=1,993) found only 39% attribute any EBIT impact to AI, most of them less than 5%. The 2026 edition (n=1,719) reportedly puts positive EBIT impact at about 37%, essentially unchanged, while the share of $1B+ firms scaling agents rose from 27% to 40%.
- **Vendor disclosures show real paid production use, at a small share of the installed base.** Microsoft reported over 30 million paid M365 Copilot seats in July 2026 (secondary estimates: about 6 to 7% of paid commercial seats). Salesforce reported more than 9,500 paid Agentforce deals and Agentforce ARR above $500M by October 2025. ServiceNow raised its 2026 AI net-new-ACV target from $1B to $1.7B. These figures are real but are also each vendor's chosen metric.
- **Counter to the "pilot purgatory" story,** Wharton/GBK (n>800 US enterprise decision-makers, June to July 2025) reports 74% positive ROI and 72% formally tracking ROI. That is self-reported and unaudited, as are the failure statistics.
- **The shared-context problem is partly a technology problem, not only an organisational one.** On Spider 2.0 (632 real enterprise text-to-SQL tasks, schemas up to 3,000+ columns) the best model solved about 17 to 21% of tasks against 91% on the older academic benchmark. LongMemEval finds commercial assistants lose about 30% accuracy when recalling information across long interactions. And the main protocol for wiring agents to business systems (MCP) has a documented record of prompt-injection and tool-poisoning exploits (GitHub MCP, WhatsApp MCP, Asana's cross-tenant exposure, Microsoft's EchoLeak CVE rated 9.3). These do not go away when the business "is ready".
- **The best controlled evidence on ROI is modest.** A randomised trial across 66 firms (7,137 workers) found Copilot cut email time by roughly a quarter but did not change meeting time, and weekly use ranged from 21% to 75% by firm. The UK Department for Business and Trade found time savings but no evidence that they improved productivity (paraphrase of the evaluation as reported). The UK's larger 20,000-person trial (26 minutes a day saved) is self-reported and not randomised.
- **Security review, not staff resistance, is a measured cause of delay.** A vendor-sponsored 2026 survey reports 82.9% of organisations had AI projects delayed by security or compliance review, about 30% of those by four months or more, and 81.6% shipped a reduced version (less autonomy or data access).

Key findings

The "pilot purgatory" statistics, report by report

MIT NANDA, "The GenAI Divide: State of AI in Business 2025"

- **[EVIDENCE (weak)]** Authors: Aditya Challapally, Chris Pease, Ramesh Raskar and Pradyumna Chari. The report is labelled "Preliminary Findings" (v0.1) and was published July/August 2025. Method: a review of 300+ publicly disclosed AI initiatives, structured interviews with representatives of 52 organisations, and survey responses from 153 senior leaders, fielded January to June 2025. Sources: AI Governance Library summary of the report (https://www.aigl.blog/state-of-ai-in-business-2025/); Virtualization Review, 19 Aug 2025 (https://virtualizationreview.com/articles/2025/08/19/mit-report-finds-most-ai-business-investments-fail-reveals-genai-divide.aspx). The PDF is hosted by MLQ (https://mlq.ai/media/quarterly_decks/v0.1_State_of_AI_in_Business_2025_Report.pdf), not on an MIT domain. I could not fetch it this session.

- **[EVIDENCE (weak)]** The headline funnel covers embedded or task-specific ("enterprise-grade") GenAI tools. About 60% of organisations evaluated them, about 20% reached pilot, and about 5% reached production with measurable P&L impact or "marked and sustained" productivity. The same report says over 80% of organisations had explored or piloted general tools such as ChatGPT or Copilot, which mainly improved individual productivity. Sources: DX newsletter "The AI Divide" (https://getdx.com/blog/the-ai-divide/); RCP Mag, 25 Aug 2025 (https://rcpmag.com/articles/2025/08/25/only-1-in-20-ai-investments-deliver-roi.aspx).
- **[EVIDENCE]** Press coverage did not report the sample consistently. Fortune (18 Aug 2025) described 150 interviews, a survey of 350 employees and 300 public deployments. Other summaries give 52 interviews and 153 survey responses. https://fortune.com/2025/08/18/mit-report-95-percent-generative-ai-pilots-at-companies-failing-cfo/
- **[OPINION]** Critics' main points (from search summaries of the critiques, not full reads):
    - The success test (marked, sustained P&L impact within about six months) is narrow and undefined, so efficiency gains count as failure.
    - The sample is small and opaque.
    - The report promotes NANDA's own agentic-web agenda, and its "connection to MIT is rather loose".

  Futuriom, Aug 2025 (https://www.futuriom.com/articles/news/why-we-dont-believe-mit-nandas-werid-ai-study/2025/08); arnon.dk (https://arnon.dk/mits-95-ai-failure-rate-is-wrong/); aioperator.io, "What the MIT study actually measured" (https://aioperator.io/blog/do-95-percent-ai-projects-fail). Those critics' further claims (that NANDA sells $250,000 memberships, and that the report's own graph was misread) appeared only in summaries of podcast and blog commentary. I have not verified them.

Gartner (forecasts)

- **[FORECAST]** 29 July 2024: at least 30% of GenAI projects will be abandoned after proof of concept by end of 2025. Stated reasons: poor data quality, inadequate risk controls, escalating costs and unclear business value. Trade coverage of the release cites a GenAI deployment cost range of $5M to $20M. https://www.gartner.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2024-07-29-gartner-predicts-30-percent-of-generative-ai-projects-will-be-abandoned-after-proof-of-concept-by-end-of-2025 (coverage: https://www.intelligentcio.com/eu/2024/08/05/gartner-predicts-30-of-generative-ai-projects-will-be-abandoned-after-proof-of-concept-by-end-of-2025/)
- **[FORECAST]** 25 June 2025: over 40% of agentic AI projects will be cancelled by end of 2027, due to escalating costs, unclear business value or inadequate risk controls. Analyst Anushree Verma described most current projects as early-stage, hype-driven experiments. https://www.gartner.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2025-06-25-gartner-predicts-over-40-percent-of-agentic-ai-projects-will-be-canceled-by-end-of-2027
- **[OPINION]** Same release: "agent washing" (rebranding assistants, RPA and chatbots as agentic) is widespread. Gartner estimates only about 130 of thousands of agentic AI vendors offer genuine agentic capability. The release gives no method for this number. Same URL.
- **[EVIDENCE (weak: self-selected webinar poll)]** The release's survey basis is a January 2025 Gartner webinar poll of 3,412 attendees. 19% said their organisation had made significant agentic AI investments. Same URL.

IDC / Lenovo

- **[EVIDENCE (weak: vendor-sponsored)]** IDC's 2025 CIO Playbook ("It's Time for AI-nomics"), sponsored by Lenovo and published Feb 2025, found 88% of observed POCs did not make it to widescale deployment: of every 33 POCs, 4 graduated to production. IDC attributed this to low organisational readiness in data, processes and IT infrastructure. CIO.com, 2025 (https://www.cio.com/article/3850763/88-of-ai-pilots-fail-to-reach-production-but-thats-not-all-on-it.html); Lenovo release (https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20250205462134/en). A secondary source gives n=2,920, which I have not verified.
- **[EVIDENCE (weak: vendor-sponsored)]** Lenovo CIO Playbook 2026 ("The Race for Enterprise AI"): IDC surveyed 3,120 IT and business decision-makers between 16 Sept and 17 Oct 2025. 46% of AI POCs have already progressed into production. Respondents projected $2.78 to $2.86 return per dollar, depending on regional edition. Business Wire, 27 Jan 2026 (https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260127255538/en/).

S&P Global Market Intelligence

- **[EVIDENCE (moderate: independent research firm; full methodology not seen)]** The share of companies abandoning most of their AI initiatives rose to 42% in 2025 from 17% the year before. The average organisation scrapped 46% of AI proofs of concept before production. Top obstacles were cost, data privacy and security risks. The survey had over 1,000 respondents (reported as 1,006 mid-level and senior IT and line-of-business staff in North America and Europe, attributed to S&P / 451 Research). Fieldwork dates are reported inconsistently (Oct to Nov 2024 vs March 2025). CIO Dive, 2025 (https://www.ciodive.com/news/AI-project-fail-data-SPGlobal/742590/); Fortune, 11 June 2025 (https://fortune.com/2025/06/11/ai-companies-employee-fatigue-failure/). I could not locate the primary S&P report.

McKinsey, The State of AI

- **[EVIDENCE (moderate: large online survey, self-reported, consultancy)]** 2025 edition ("Agents, innovation, and transformation", Nov 2025): n=1,993 participants in 105 countries, fielded 25 June to 29 July 2025.
    - 39% attribute any level of EBIT impact to AI, and most of those say under 5% of EBIT.
    - 62% are at least experimenting with AI agents.
    - In no business function do more than 10% say they are scaling agents.
    - "High performers" (5%+ of EBIT from AI) are about 6% of respondents.

  https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/quantumblack/our-insights/the-state-of-ai

- **[EVIDENCE (moderate)]** 2026 edition ("On the road to ROI", Aug 2026): n=1,719 in 97 countries, fielded 4 May to 8 June 2026.
    - Among organisations with $1B+ revenue, the share scaling AI agents rose to 40% from 27%. Smaller organisations were flat at 22%.
    - Agent scaling is most common in IT (12%) and knowledge management (11%), and lowest in manufacturing (3%).
    - Positive EBIT impact is about 37%, roughly unchanged.

  PDF: https://www.mckinsey.com/~/media/mckinsey/business%20functions/quantumblack/our%20insights/the%20state%20of%20ai/the-state-of-ai-in-2026-on-the-road-to-roi-aug-2026.pdf. The figures come from secondary summaries (https://idm.net.au/node/15761; h

ttps://digitalstrategy-ai.com/mckinsey-state-of-ai-2026), not from my own read of the PDF. Treat them as provisional.

Deloitte, State of AI in the Enterprise 2026

- **[EVIDENCE (moderate: consultancy survey)]** Over 3,000 director-to-C-suite leaders directly involved in AI (one summary says 3,235 in 24 countries). Only 25% of respondents have moved 40% or more of their AI pilots into production. https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/about/press-room/state-of-ai-report-2026.html

- **[EVIDENCE (weak: figures conflict)]** On agentic AI, summaries of the same report disagree:

    - 23% report at least moderate use today, and 46% expect that within two years (https://marketscale.com/industries/software-and-technology/enterprise-ai-moves-from-pilot-to-production-in-2026-but-gaps-in-governance-and-talent-persist).
    - Close to three-quarters plan to deploy agentic AI within two years (https://www.deloitte.com/nl/en/about/press-room/state-of-ai-in-the-enterprise-2026.html).

  The "only 21% have mature governance for agents" figure appears only in third-party summaries. Not verified.

BCG, "The Widening AI Value Gap" (Build for the Future 2025)

- **[OPINION / EVIDENCE (weak: consultancy survey with self-assessed maturity)]** Over 1,250 senior executives across nine industries, Sept 2025. 5% are "future-built" and achieving bottom-line value at scale. About 60% are laggards and about 35% "scalers" (the 60/35 split is from secondary summaries). BCG names agentic AI as the main accelerator of the gap. https://web-assets.bcg.com/35/20/636ea73746f8bc91f106ca56ee7c/jpr-2501023-widening-ai-value-gap-vf.pdf ; coverage: https://www.artificialintelligence-news.com/news/value-gap-ai-investments-widening-dangerously-fast/

RAND, "The Root Causes of Failure for Artificial Intelligence Projects and How They Can Succeed" (13 Aug 2024)

- **[EVIDENCE (qualitative: interviews)]** Authors: Ryseff, De Bruhl and Newberry. Secondary sources say the study is based on interviews with 65 experienced data scientists and engineers. The five root causes include:

    - stakeholders misunderstanding or miscommunicating what problem AI should solve;
    - inadequate data and deployment infrastructure;
    - a focus on the latest technology over real user problems.

  https://www.rand.org/pubs/research_reports/RRA2680-1.html

- **[EVIDENCE: provenance note]** RAND's "more than 80% of AI projects fail, twice the rate of non-AI IT projects" is attributed in the report to "some estimates". RAND did not measure it. Same URL.

Wharton / GBK Collective, "Accountable Acceleration" (28 Oct 2025)

- **[EVIDENCE (moderate: annual survey, self-reported ROI)]** Over 800 US enterprise decision-makers, June to July 2025. 82% use GenAI at least weekly, 46% daily, 72% track structured ROI metrics, and 74% report positive ROI (+9 points). https://

knowledge.wharton.upenn.edu/special-report/2025-ai-adoption-report ; https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20251028556241/en

Agentic and GenAI systems in production: what vendors disclose

- **[EVIDENCE (company-reported metric)]** Microsoft:
  - Q2 FY26 (28 Jan 2026): 15 million paid M365 Copilot seats among about 450 million M365 commercial seats (about 3.3%). https://www.directionsonmicrosoft.com/blog/microsoft-claims-15-million-paid-m365-copilot-seats
  - Q3 FY26 (29 Apr 2026): 20 million.
  - Q4 FY26 (July 2026): over 30 million (secondary estimate: about 6.6 to 6.7% of paid commercial seats). https://www.uctoday.com/unified-communications/microsoft-365-copilot-passes-30-million-paid-seats-as-cloud-and-ai-growth-power-record-quarter

  Microsoft discloses seats, not usage depth or unit economics.

- **[EVIDENCE (company-reported metric)]** Salesforce Q3 FY26 (quarter to 31 Oct 2025, reported 3 Dec 2025):
  - more than 18,500 Agentforce deals since launch, of which over 9,500 paid (+50% quarter on quarter);
  - Agentforce plus Data 360 ARR nearly $1.4B (+114% YoY);
  - Agentforce ARR above $500M (+330% YoY).

  https://www.salesforce.com/news/press-releases/2025/12/03/fy26-q3-earnings/ ; PDF: https://s205.q4cdn.com/626266368/files/doc_financials/2026/q3/CRM-Q3-FY26-Earnings-Press-Release.pdf. I could not retrieve later quarters (search budget exhausted).

- **[EVIDENCE (company-reported metric)]** ServiceNow:
  - Now Assist net new ACV topped $600M in Q4 2025, against a $1B+ target for 2026.
  - The target was raised to $1.5B at Q1 2026 and to $1.7B at Q3 2026.
  - 19 deals over $5M net new ACV in Q3 2026.

  Form 8-K Q3 FY2026: https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/0001373715/000137371526000092/erq3fy26.htm ; Q4 2025 call coverage: https://finance.yahoo.com/news/servicenow-q4-earnings-call-highlights-024438096.html

- **[OPINION]** Reading: these are real paid deployments at scale, which contradicts the strong form of "pilot purgatory". But "paid deal", "seat" and "ACV" are bookings metrics. None of the three vendors discloses active usage, task completion or customer-side ROI. The Salesforce paid-deal count (9,500) is small relative to its customer base.

The shared-context problem, technically (gap-fill pass)

All items in this section and the ones below rest on search extracts; no page was fetched.

Structured enterprise data (text-to-SQL, the "semantic layer" problem)

- **[EVIDENCE: peer-reviewed benchmark]** Spider 2.0 (Lei et al., arXiv 2411.07763, first posted Nov 2024, v2 March 2025; ICLR 2025) uses 632 real enterprise workflow tasks across BigQuery, Snowflake and other dialects, some schemas exceeding 3,000 columns. o1-preview solved about 17% in the original version and about 21.3% with the agent framework in v2,

against 91.2% on Spider 1.0 and 73.0% on BIRD. GPT-4o reached about 10%. The project leaderboard later shows systems at about 38 to 41%, on varying subsets. https://arxiv.org/abs/2411.07763 ; https://spider2-sql.github.io/ (search extract)

- Reading: the gap between clean academic schemas and real enterprise warehouses is large. This is the nearest measured evidence for why "semantic layers" (curated definitions of business metrics) are sold as a fix. I found no independent controlled study showing how much a semantic layer closes the gap; vendor claims only. Treat "add a context layer" as a plausible hypothesis, not a measured result.

Unstructured enterprise documents (RAG)

- **[EVIDENCE (weak: abstracts only)]** Narita et al. (arXiv 2604.02640, AAAI 2026 workshop) tag enterprise RAG queries on four difficulty axes and report that conventional accuracy metrics hide weaknesses in multi-hop, arithmetic and logic-heavy queries; agentic modular improvements helped retrieval but not reasoning. https://arxiv.org/abs/2604.02640 (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE (weak: abstract only)]** EnterpriseRAG (arXiv 2608.11584, 2026): 983 expert-validated samples across six domains, built around retrieval noise, knowledge gaps and factual conflicts, which the authors say prior benchmarks ignored. No headline results seen. https://arxiv.org/pdf/2608.11584 (search extract)
- **[OPINION: vendor claim]** A RAG-evaluation vendor (FutureAGI) claims retrieval caused about 58% of quality regressions across 40+ enterprise deployments. Internal vendor data, not checkable. Do not cite as evidence. https://futureagi.com/glossary/rag-evaluation/ (search extract)
- I found no large independent empirical study of RAG failure rates on real enterprise corpora. The benchmark literature consistently says real enterprise documents (tables, scans, conflicting versions) are harder than academic sets, but gives no production failure rate.

Agent memory

- **[EVIDENCE: peer-reviewed benchmark]** LongMemEval (Wu et al., arXiv 2410.10813; ICLR 2025): 500 curated questions embedded in long chat histories. The abstract reports commercial chat assistants and long-context LLMs show about a 30% accuracy drop when memorising information across sustained interactions. The full paper gives a 30 to 60% drop for long-context models and 30 to 70% accuracy for commercial systems in a simpler setting. The drop is relative to an oracle-retrieval baseline. https://arxiv.org/abs/2410.10813 (search extract)
- Reading: this directly tests "agents that remember the business". Memory is an unsolved technical problem, which cuts against "the tech is the easy part".

MCP: adoption numbers and documented security incidents (gap-fill pass)

Adoption

- **[EVIDENCE (company-reported, via secondary sources)]** Anthropic reportedly counted more than 10,000 active public MCP servers in December 2025, and reported about 97 million monthly SDK downloads in March 2026. I did not see the Anthropic primary posts; both figures came from secondary blogs. Downloads measure developer activity (including CI pipelines), not enterprise production use. https://nordicapis.com/10-interesting-mcp-statistics/ ; https://dev.to/gentic_news/mcp-hits-10k-servers-97m-monthly-sdk-downloads-by-may-2026-1jbk (search extract)

- **[EVIDENCE (weak: vendor survey, n=300)]** Stacklok, "State of MCP in Software 2026": 300 senior technical leaders at software organisations surveyed December 2025; a write-up reports 41% in limited or broad production with MCP servers. Software firms only, vendor-run. https://stacklok.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/01/State-of-MCP-in-Software-2026_FINAL.pdf (search extract)

Incidents and vulnerabilities (all disclosed in 2025)

- **[EVIDENCE: researcher disclosure]** Tool poisoning, Invariant Labs, April 2025. A malicious MCP server's tool description, never itself called, steered an agent (tested in Cursor) to exfiltrate a user's WhatsApp history through a trusted WhatsApp MCP server, bypassing the user-approval step. An earlier proof of concept hid an instruction to read ~/.ssh/id_rsa in an "add" tool's description. https://invariantlabs.ai/blog/whatsapp-mcp-exploited (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE: researcher disclosure]** GitHub MCP, Invariant Labs, 26 May 2025. A prompt injection planted in a public repository issue could make an agent using the official GitHub MCP server read the user's private repositories and leak their contents in a public pull request. Invariant says it is architectural (agent has private data, reads untrusted input and can write publicly), so a server-side patch cannot fix it. No CVE surfaced. https://invariantlabs.ai/blog/mcp-github-vulnerability ; https://devclass.com/2025/05/27/researchers-warn-of-prompt-injection-vulnerability-in-github-mcp-with-no-obvious-fix/ (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE: company disclosure via press]** Asana MCP server, June 2025. Asana launched its MCP server on 1 May, found a logic flaw on 4 June, took it offline, and notified customers on 16 June. Data from one organisation (projects, comments, files) could be visible to users of other organisations, within each user's access scope. Asana said it was a bug, not an attack. A spokesperson told BleepingComputer about 1,000 customers were affected; The Register said the company would not give a number. A widely repeated $7.5M cost figure is an estimate from secondary sources, not from Asana. https://bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/asana-warns-mcp-ai-feature-exposed-customer-data-to-other-orgs/ ; https://theregister.com/2025/06/18/asana_mcp_server_bug/ (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE: vendor CVE]** EchoLeak, CVE-2025-32711, disclosed June 2025 by Aim Security. A zero-click indirect prompt injection in Microsoft 365 Copilot: a crafted email could cause Copilot to exfiltrate data from the user's M365 context without any click. Microsoft rated it Critical (CVSS 9.3), fixed it server-side, required no customer action, and said it had no evidence of exploitation. https://thehackernews.com/2025/06/zero-click-ai-vulnerability-exposes.html ; MSRC entry: https://msrc.microsoft.com/update-guide/vulnerability/CVE-2025-32711 (search extract; MSRC URL constructed from the CVE ID, not seen in results)
- **[EVIDENCE: academic scan]** Hasan et al. (arXiv 2506.13538, 2025) analysed 1,899 open-source MCP servers: 7.2% had general vulnerabilities and 5.5% showed MCP-specific tool poisoning. https://arxiv.org/pdf/2506.13538v2 (search extract)
- Reading: the protocol that makes "one shared context for humans and agents" practical also creates the "lethal trifecta" (private data, untrusted input, an outbound channel). A shared context store is a larger blast radius. The fix is architectural (scoped permissions, isolation), which is engineering work, not readiness work.

Bank and retailer deployments with disclosed numbers (gap-fill pass)

- **[EVIDENCE (company-reported, via press)]** JPMorgan Chase, LLM Suite: about 200,000 employees onboarded within roughly eight months of the 2024 launch (Bloomberg via American Banker). Chief data and analytics officer Teresa Heitsenrether told the WSJ about half use it actively every day, saving an hour or two a week each, and called it early stage. A later investor update cited by secondary sources gives about 150,000 weekly users saving

about four hours each (year not clear in the extract). https://www.americanbanker.com/news/how-jpmorganchase-democratized-employee-access-to-gen-ai (search extract). A claim that Dimon said JPMorgan spends about $2B a year on AI and books about $2B of benefits comes only from a blog (https://ai2.work/blog/how-jpmorgan-s-ai-now-pays-for-itself-inside-the-2b-bet); one analysis notes the shareholder letter's "value" figure is internal and not reconciled to revenue or costs (https://stockti.com/jpmorgan-s-ai-integration-deepens-yet-financial-impact-remains-elusive). Treat the $2B as unverified.

- **[EVIDENCE (company-reported)]** Bank of America, Erica: more than 3 billion cumulative client interactions and nearly 50 million users since the 2018 launch (20 Aug 2025); 676 million interactions in 2024 alone, cumulative over 2.5 billion (Feb 2025); over 3.2 billion cumulative by March 2026. https://newsroom.bankofamerica.com/content/newsroom/press-releases/2025/08/a-decade-of-ai-innovation--bofa-s-virtual-assistant-erica-surpas.html ; https://newsroom.bankofamerica.com/content/newsroom/press-releases/2025/02/digital-interactions-by-bofa-clients-surge-to-over-26-billion--u.html (search extract). Erica is a mostly scripted assistant built over seven years, not a GenAI agent. Its scale shows how long mature customer-facing AI took to build.
- **[EVIDENCE (company-reported, via press)]** Goldman Sachs: the GS AI Assistant went firmwide on 24 June 2025 to about 46,000 staff after a 10,000-person pilot; the bank says employees write about a million prompts a month. CIO Marco Argenti said it would deploy "hundreds", possibly thousands, of Cognition's Devin coding agents alongside about 12,000 developers, under human supervision. His 3 to 4x productivity expectation is a FORECAST. https://www.americanbanker.com/news/goldman-sachs-staff-now-write-a-million-gen-ai-prompts-a-month (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE (company-reported, earnings call, via press)]** Walmart: on the August 2026 earnings call CEO John Furner said Sparky (customer shopping agent) users were up 70% year on year and spend 40% more per order; in February 2026 the CFO had cited 35% higher average order value. Walmart runs four "super agents" (customers, suppliers and sellers, associates, developers). An older figure has 900,000 associates asking 3 million questions a week of its associate AI tool. https://www.ciodive.com/news/walmart-AI-wins-sparky-john-furner/812606/ ; https://www.retaildive.com/news/walmart-artificial-intelligence-ai-super-agents-retail-associates/753996/ (search extract). The spend-per-order figure is a correlation: heavier shoppers are likelier to use the assistant. It is not a causal estimate.
- Reading: banks deploy GenAI widely to employees (internal assistants, coding agents) and cautiously to customers. None of the four discloses audited ROI. The pattern supports "production is real" and also "production is mostly employee copilots, not autonomous agents".

Procurement, security and governance timelines (gap-fill pass)

- **[EVIDENCE (weak: vendor-sponsored survey; n not seen)]** Protegrity with Enterprise Management Associates, reported July 2026, survey of IT and security leaders: 82.9% had AI projects delayed before production by security or compliance review; over two-thirds of delayed projects stalled at least a month and nearly 30% four months or more; 81.6% deployed AI in reduced form (limits on agent autonomy or data access); 69% run agents that can write to databases or trigger APIs, but only 19.7% deploy highly autonomous systems. https://securitybrief.co.uk/story/enterprise-ai-deployments-slowed-by-security-reviews (search extract). A 47.4% "CISO approves" figure is reported inconsistently; do not use it.
- **[EVIDENCE (weak: vendor survey)]** Apono, "2026 State of Agentic AI Cyber Risk" (fieldwork Dec 2025): 98% said security and data concerns had already affected agentic projects; 21% cited significant delays or reduced scope; only 21% felt prepared for attacks

involving agents. https://securitybrief.co.uk/story/security-chiefs-hit-brakes-on-risky-agentic-ai-roll-out (search extract)

- No source found with months from pilot to signed contract. The UK DBT and GDS trials (below) each ran about three months; the Australian trial about six months. That is a floor for public-sector evaluation cycles, not a procurement benchmark.

Controlled ROI evidence vs vendor ROI (gap-fill pass)

Randomised or quasi-experimental

- **[EVIDENCE: randomised field experiment]** Dillon, Jaffe, Immorlica and Stanton, "Shifting Work Patterns with Generative AI", NBER WP 33795 (2025). Microsoft researchers with academic co-authors; 66 large firms, 7,137 workers (earlier versions said about 6,000), half randomly given M365 Copilot for six months, Sept 2023 to Oct 2024. Copilot cut email time by nearly 3 hours a week for users (about 25%, LATE estimate) but produced no change in meeting time, the most common use. Weekly use among treated workers ranged from 21% to 75% by firm. https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w33795/w33795.pdf (search extract). Note: Microsoft-affiliated authors, but a randomised design. The firm-level spread in use is itself evidence that organisation matters.
- **[EVIDENCE: peer-reviewed quasi-experiment]** Brynjolfsson, Li and Raymond, "Generative AI at Work", QJE 140(2), 2025: staggered rollout of an AI assistant to 5,172 customer-support agents (5,179 in the 2023 NBER version). Resolutions per hour rose 14 to 15% on average and about 34% for novices, with small speed gains and small quality declines for the most skilled. https://econpapers.repec.org/RePEc:oup:qjecon:v:140:y:2025:i:2:p:889-942 ; https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w31161/w31161.pdf (search extract)

Government evaluations (not randomised unless noted)

- **[EVIDENCE (moderate: government evaluation, partly random selection)]** UK Department for Business and Trade, M365 Copilot pilot, about 1,000 licences, Oct to Dec 2024 (some reports say to March 2025); mostly volunteers, 30% randomly selected. Found time savings on writing tasks, but reported finding no evidence that the time saved led to improved productivity (paraphrase; wording seen only in search extracts). Some tasks got slower (scheduling took about 35 minutes longer; image generation about 30 minutes longer). 72% satisfied. DBT noted productivity was not the main focus and value for money needs further evaluation. Published around 4 Sept 2025. https://www.theregister.com/2025/09/04/m365_copilot_uk_government ; https://www.civilserviceworld.com/news/article/dbt-trial-finds-copilot-saves-staff-time-but-doesnt-improve-productivity (search extract). The primary DBT report URL did not surface.
- **[EVIDENCE (weak to moderate: government evaluation, self-reported)]** UK GDS cross-government M365 Copilot experiment: 20,000 staff in 12 organisations, 30 Sept to 31 Dec 2024. Average self-reported saving 26 minutes a day (about 13 working days a year); 35 minutes for project delivery, 11 minutes for tax. Published June 2025. https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/microsoft-365-copilot-experiment-cross-government-findings-report/microsoft-365-copilot-experiment-cross-government-findings-report-html ; PDF: https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/683db42bd23a62e5d32680d0/M365_Copilot_Experiment_Findings_Report.pdf (search extract). Self-reported time, not measured output. The government press release headline ("nearly 2 weeks a year") is an extrapolation.

- **[EVIDENCE (weak to moderate: government evaluation, non-random sample)]** Australian Digital Transformation Agency whole-of-government Copilot trial, evaluated by Nous Group, published Oct 2024: more than 7,600 staff in dozens of agencies, first half of 2024. Users reported gains in summarising, first drafts and search; 1 in 3 used it daily; 77% optimistic at the end. The evaluation itself flags inconsistent rollout and a non-randomised sample; participants said they often forgot Copilot was there. As of January 2025 the DTA planned no further whole-of-government GenAI trials. https://www.digital.gov.au/initiatives/copilot-trial/summary-evaluation-findings/cts-executive-summary ; https://www.itnews.com.au/news/gov-copilot-trial-unsettled-by-usage-and-unmet-expectation-612580 (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE (weak: internal evaluation)]** Australian Treasury, 14-week trial with 218 staff: concluded GenAI can be deployed in Treasury but with limitations. https://evaluation.treasury.gov.au/publications/evaluation-generative-artificial-intelligence (search extract)

Vendor-commissioned ROI (for contrast)

- **[OPINION: vendor-commissioned projection]** Forrester Total Economic Impact studies commissioned by Microsoft. Most are labelled "New Technology Projected" TEI, i.e. modelled on a composite organisation from a few customer interviews, not measured. Examples: Teams with M365 Copilot (2025), projected ROI 122% to 408%; M365 Copilot for SMBs (Oct 2024), 132% to 353%; M365 Copilot (April 2024), modelled on a 25,000-person composite US organisation. https://tei.forrester.com/go/Microsoft/TeamsandCopilot/ ; https://tei.forrester.com/go/microsoft/smb365copilot/ ; https://tei.forrester.com/go/microsoft/365Copilot (search extract). I could not trace figures of 116% or 457% sometimes attributed to Forrester Copilot studies.
- Reading: the projected TEI ROI (hundreds of percent) and the controlled evidence (email time down about a quarter, no meeting change; no measured productivity gain at DBT) differ by an order of magnitude in tone. Use the controlled studies.

Viral statistics traced

Statistic as quoted	Where people cite it from	Where it actually comes from	How solid
"95% of AI pilots fail"	MIT, via Fortune (18 Aug 2025)	MIT NANDA preliminary report. 5% of organisations got custom or embedded GenAI tools into production with measurable P&L impact within about 6 months. Based on 52 interviews, 153 surveys and about 300 public cases.	Weak. Narrow success definition, small non-random sample, preliminary, and the unit is organisations not pilots. It says nothing about general-purpose tools, which 80%+ had tried.
"88% of POCs never reach production" / "4 in 33"	IDC	IDC CIO Playbook 2025, sponsored by Lenovo. "Observed" POCs, reason given as low readiness.	Weak to moderate. Vendor-sponsored, and the same pair reported 46% reaching production a year later.
"42% of companies abandoned most AI initiatives"	S&P Global	S&P Global Market Intelligence survey of about 1,006 IT and LOB respondents in North America and Europe	Moderate. Independent firm, but the primary report was not found and fieldwork dates conflict. "Most of their initiatives" is a company-level measure.
"46% of POCs scrapped"	S&P Global	Same survey, average per organisation	Moderate, same caveats. Do not confuse with Lenovo/IDC's "46% progressed into production" (2026).

Statistic as quoted	Where people cite it from	Where it actually comes from	How solid
"30% of GenAI projects abandoned after PoC"	Gartner	July 2024 forecast for end-2025	A forecast. Often misquoted as a measured outcome. No outcome check published that I found.
"Over 40% of agentic projects cancelled"	Gartner	June 2025 forecast for end-2027	A forecast. The quoted survey is a self-selected webinar poll.
"Only ~130 real agentic vendors"	Gartner	Same June 2025 release	Analyst estimate, method not published.
"80% of AI projects fail, twice IT"	RAND	RAND attributes it to "some estimates"	Second-hand. RAND's own contribution is qualitative interviews, not a rate.
"43% of MCP servers have command injection flaws"	Security blogs and MCP explainers, 2025-26	Traces to vendor scans (Adversa AI of 500+ servers; one blog attributes it to a 50-server scan with a 22-rule scanner). The peer-reviewed-style scan of 1,899 open-source servers (arXiv 2506.13538) found 7.2% with general vulnerabilities and 5.5% with tool poisoning.	Weak. Use the arXiv figures instead.
"Copilot saves civil servants two weeks a year"	UK government press release, June 2025	GDS experiment, 20,000 staff: 26 minutes a day self-reported, extrapolated to about 13 working days	Moderate as a self-report; not measured output. DBT's separate evaluation found no evidence of a productivity improvement.
"87% of data science projects never make it into production"	VentureBeat, 19 Jul 2019	Commentators find it hard to trace to underlying data. Variants: 85% (Gartner analyst, 2017), 85.4% (Forbes, 2020).	Very weak. A pre-GenAI figure recycled into GenAI discussions. Sources: https://towardsdatascience.com/the-gap-between-data-science-and-the-organization-7cfa8b0e2be5 ; https://builtin.com/articles/why-machine-learning-projects-fail-data-science-engineering

Strongest counter-evidence

Against the thesis ("tech is the easy part; the business isn't ready")

- Gartner's stated reasons for both abandonment forecasts are escalating cost, unclear business value and inadequate risk controls (plus poor data quality in 2024). S&P's respondents named cost, data privacy and security as top obstacles. These are economics and risk problems. Better workflow description or less staff resistance would not necessarily fix them. (Gartner URLs above; https://www.ciodive.com/news/AI-project-fail-data-SPGlobal/742590/)
- Even the MIT report, often cited for "organisational" failure, frames its divide around tools that do not deliver P&L impact in narrow windows. Its strongest critics argue the time window, not the organisation, drives the result. (https://aioperator.io/blog/do-95-percent-ai-projects-fail)
- Where the thesis does get support:
  - IDC attributes low conversion to data, process and IT readiness.
  - RAND's first root cause is stakeholders misunderstanding what problem to solve, which is close to "nobody can describe the real workflow". RAND's sample is data scientists and engineers, so this is the builders' view of their clients.

- **The technical record on shared context says "the tech is the easy part" is wrong for this specific layer (gap-fill pass).** Frontier models solve about a fifth of real enterprise text-to-SQL tasks (Spider 2.0), lose about 30% accuracy on long-term memory (LongMemEval), and the main integration protocol (MCP) had four documented exploit classes or incidents in 2025 (tool poisoning, GitHub MCP, Asana cross-tenant exposure, EchoLeak at CVSS 9.3). Invariant's verdict on GitHub MCP was that it cannot be patched server-side. A business with perfect workflow documentation and enthusiastic staff still faces all of these. (URLs in the sections above.)
- **Security review, not people, is a measured delay.** 82.9% of organisations in the Protegrity/EMA survey reported AI projects delayed by security or compliance review, and 81.6% shipped a reduced-autonomy version (vendor survey). (https://securitybrief.co.uk/story/enterprise-ai-deployments-slowed-by-security-reviews)
- **Where the thesis gets support from the controlled studies:** in the 66-firm randomised trial, weekly Copilot use among workers given access ranged from 21% to 75% depending on the firm. The same tool, randomly assigned, was used three times as much in some organisations as in others. That is evidence that organisational factors drive uptake. (https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w33795/w33795.pdf)

Against the mainstream "pilot purgatory" reading

- Wharton/GBK: 74% of 800+ US enterprise decision-makers report positive ROI, and 72% track it formally.
- Lenovo/IDC 2026: 46% of POCs reached production.
- McKinsey 2026: 40% of $1B+ firms scaling agents.
- Paid vendor metrics: 30M Copilot seats, 9,500+ paid Agentforce deals, ServiceNow AI ACV target raised 70%.

All are self-reported or vendor metrics, but they are no weaker than the failure statistics they contradict.

- Bank-scale internal deployment is real (gap-fill pass): about 200,000 JPMorgan employees on LLM Suite, about 46,000 Goldman staff on the GS AI Assistant, 3 billion+ cumulative Erica interactions at Bank of America. These are company-reported and say nothing about ROI, but they are not pilots.
- Against the "AI pays off" reading: the UK DBT evaluation found no evidence that time saved became productivity, and the randomised Microsoft-affiliated trial found email time fell but meeting time did not change. (https://www.theregister.com/2025/09/04/m365_copilot_uk_government ; https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w33795/w33795.pdf)
- The failure and success statistics use incompatible denominators. A 5% org-level P&L metric (MIT), a 12% POC-level conversion (IDC 2025) and a 46% POC-level conversion (IDC 2026) can all be "true" at once. The honest statement is that conversion and profit impact are low and poorly measured, not that "95% fail".

Open questions

1. Does the MIT NANDA report itself say that purchased vendor tools succeed about twice as often as internal builds, and that the core barrier is a "learning gap" (tools that do not retain context or adapt)? Both are widely repeated. I could not verify either this session. If true, the second is a technology limitation, which cuts against "tech is the easy part".

2. Did Gartner ever publish an outcome check on its "30% abandoned by end of 2025" forecast?
3. Why did IDC/Lenovo's POC-to-production rate jump from 12% to 46% in one year? Same question, same sampling frame?
4. Salesforce Q1 and Q2 FY27 Agentforce paid-deal and ARR figures, and churn or renewal data. Not retrieved.
5. Banks and retail (partly answered in the gap-fill pass): user counts now sourced, but via press. Still needed: JPMorgan's own investor-day or annual-report wording on LLM Suite users and AI "value", and whether the $2B benefit figure is real; Walmart's primary transcript for the Sparky 35% vs 40% spend figures.
6. Incident and post-mortem record for agents in production (partly answered): four MCP/Copilot security disclosures are sourced. Still missing: operational incidents (data deletion, wrong customer commitments, outages) and any legal rulings on agent errors. Check track 06.
7. Shared-context technical evidence (partly answered): Spider 2.0, LongMemEval and MCP scans are sourced. Still missing: an independent production RAG failure rate on real enterprise corpora; any controlled test of semantic or context layers. Leads not verified: arXiv 2605.04421 (reported scan of about 200,000 MCP servers, 14.3% with injectable tool descriptions) and arXiv 2608.00150 ("Exposed by Design", live-server testing).
8. Procurement (partly answered): security-review delay data found (Protegrity/EMA, Apono). Still missing: months from pilot to signed contract, with method.
9. Controlled ROI (answered in part): Dillon et al. NBER 33795, Brynjolfsson et al. QJE 2025, UK DBT and GDS, Australian DTA. Still missing: the DBT primary report URL and its exact sample design; a controlled study of agentic (not assistant) deployments.

What's genuinely uncertain

- **The true production conversion rate.** Credible-looking sources put it anywhere between 5% and about 50%, depending on unit and definition. No source in this pass uses a random sample with audited outcomes.
- **Whether ROI is rising.** McKinsey shows flat EBIT impact (about 39% in 2025, about 37% in 2026) while Wharton shows rising self-reported ROI (74%, +9 points). Both are self-reports from different populations.
- **How much "agentic" production is real agents vs relabelled assistants.** Gartner's own 130-vendor estimate has no published method.
- **Whether vendor bookings metrics (seats, paid deals, ACV) translate into usage and customer value.** No vendor discloses usage depth.
- **Whether time saved becomes output.** The UK GDS (26 minutes a day, self-reported) and DBT (no evidence of productivity improvement) evaluations of the same product in the same government in the same quarter point in different directions. The randomised trial shows reallocation (less email) more than measured output gains.
- **How fast the context-layer technology is improving.** Spider 2.0 scores rose from about 17% to about 40% on the leaderboard within roughly 18 months. A technical constraint that is real in 2025 may shrink by 2027; the organisational constraints may not.

Numbers for the facts file

Figure	What it measures	Source	URL	Date	Reliability note
5% (95% "fail")	Orgs whose custom or embedded GenAI tools reached production with measurable	MIT NANDA, GenAI Divide	https://getdx.com/blog/the-ai-divide/ (summary); PDF at mlq.ai	Jul/ Aug 2025	Weak: preliminary, 52 interviews + 153 surveys + ~300

Figure	What it measures	Source	URL	Date	Reliability note
	P&L impact (funnel 60% evaluated, 20% piloted, 5% production)				public cases, ~6-month P&L window
30%	GenAI projects to be abandoned after PoC by end-2025	Gartner press release	https://www.gartner.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2024-07-29-gartner-predicts-30-percent-of-generative-ai-projects-will-be-abandoned-after-proof-of-concept-by-end-of-2025	29 Jul 2024	FORECAST
>40%	Agentic AI projects cancelled by end-2027	Gartner press release	https://www.gartner.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2025-06-25-gartner-predicts-over-40-percent-of-agentic-ai-projects-will-be-canceled-by-end-of-2027	25 Jun 2025	FORECAST
~130	Vendors with genuine agentic capability, out of "thousands"	Gartner, same release	same	25 Jun 2025	Analyst estimate, no method
19% (n=3,412)	Orgs with significant agentic investment	Gartner webinar poll, Jan 2025	same	25 Jun 2025	Self-selected webinar audience
88% / 4 of 33	Observed AI POCs not reaching widescale deployment	IDC CIO Playbook 2025 (Lenovo-sponsored)	https://www.cio.com/article/3850763/88-of-ai-pilots-fail-to-reach-production-but-thats-not-all-on-it.html	Feb/ Mar 2025	Vendor-sponsored, n unverified
46%	AI POCs progressed into production	Lenovo CIO Playbook 2026 (IDC, n=3,120, fieldwork 16 Sep-17 Oct 2025)	https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260127255538/en/	27 Jan 2026	Vendor-sponsored
42% (from 17%)	Companies abandoning most of their AI initiatives	S&P Global Market Intelligence (n≈1,006, NA + Europe)	https://www.ciodive.com/news/AI-project-fail-data-SPGlobal/742590/	2025	Primary report not seen, fieldwork dates conflict
46%	Average share of AI POCs scrapped before production	S&P Global MI	same	2025	As above
39%	Respondents attributing any EBIT impact to AI (most <5%)	McKinsey State of AI 2025 (n=1,993)	https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/quantumblack/our-insights/the-state-of-ai	Nov 2025	Self-reported, consultancy
≤10%	Max share scaling agents in any single function	McKinsey 2025	same	Nov 2025	Self-reported
40% (from 27%)	$1B+ revenue orgs scaling AI agents	McKinsey State of AI 2026 (n=1,719)	https://www.mckinsey.com/~/media/mckinsey/business%20functions/quantumblack/our%20insights/the%20state%20of%20ai/the-state-of-ai-in-2026-on-the-road-to-roi-aug-2026.pdf	Aug 2026	Via secondary summaries, verify in PDF
25%	Respondents who moved 40% + of AI pilots into production	Deloitte State of AI in the Enterprise 2026 (n>3,000)	https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/about/press-room/state-of-ai-report-2026.html	early 2026	Consultancy survey
5%	"Future-built" companies achieving AI value at scale	BCG Widening AI Value Gap (n>1,250)	https://web-assets.bcg.com/35/20/636ea73746f8bc91f106ca56ee7c/jpr-2501023-widening-ai-value-gap-vf.pdf	Sep 2025	Consultancy maturity typology
74%	Enterprise leaders reporting positive GenAI ROI	Wharton/GBK (n>800 US)	https://knowledge.wharton.upenn.edu/special-report/2025-ai-adoption-report	28 Oct 2025	Self-reported ROI

Figure	What it measures	Source	URL	Date	Reliability note
80%	"AI projects fail", cited by RAND	RAND RRA2680-1 citing "some estimates"	https://www.rand.org/pubs/research_reports/RRA2680-1.html	13 Aug 2024	Second-hand estimate, not RAND's measurement
30M+	Paid M365 Copilot seats (~6.6-6.7% of paid commercial seats, analyst estimate)	Microsoft Q4 FY26 earnings call	https://www.uctoday.com/unified-communications/microsoft-365-copilot-passes-30-million-paid-seats-as-cloud-and-ai-growth-power-record-quarter	Jul 2026	Company metric, secondary report
15M	Paid M365 Copilot seats, of ~450M commercial	Microsoft Q2 FY26	https://www.directionsonmicrosoft.com/blog/microsoft-claims-15-million-paid-m365-copilot-seats	28-29 Jan 2026	Company metric
9,500+ / >$500M	Paid Agentforce deals / Agentforce ARR	Salesforce Q3 FY26 release	https://www.salesforce.com/news/press-releases/2025/12/03/fy26-q3-earnings/	3 Dec 2025	Company metric
$1.7B	ServiceNow 2026 AI net new ACV target (raised from $1B)	ServiceNow Q3 2026 8-K	https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/0001373715/000137371526000092/erq3fy26.htm	Oct 2026	Company target, not revenue
~17% to 21.3% (vs 91.2% Spider 1.0)	Best model success on 632 real enterprise text-to-SQL tasks	Spider 2.0, arXiv 2411.07763	https://arxiv.org/abs/2411.07763	Nov 2024 / v2 Mar 2025	Peer-reviewed benchmark; leaderboard later ~41%; search extract
~30%	Accuracy drop of commercial assistants and long-context LLMs on long-term memory	LongMemEval, arXiv 2410.10813 (ICLR 2025)	https://arxiv.org/abs/2410.10813	2024-25	Relative to oracle retrieval; search extract
7.2% / 5.5%	Open-source MCP servers with general vulnerabilities / tool poisoning (n=1,899)	Hasan et al., arXiv 2506.13538	https://arxiv.org/pdf/2506.13538v2	2025	Academic scan; search extract
9.3	CVSS score of EchoLeak (CVE-2025-32711), zero-click M365 Copilot prompt injection	Microsoft / Aim Security	https://thehackernews.com/2025/06/zero-click-ai-vulnerability-exposes.html	Jun 2025	Vendor CVE; fixed, no known exploitation; search extract
~1,000	Asana customers potentially exposed by MCP server bug	Asana spokesperson to BleepingComputer	https://bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/asana-warns-mcp-ai-feature-exposed-customer-data-to-other-orgs/	Jun 2025	Company statement via press; Asana declined to confirm to other outlets
>10,000 / ~97M	Active public MCP servers (Dec 2025) / monthly SDK downloads (Mar 2026)	Anthropic, via secondary blogs	https://nordicapis.com/10-interesting-mcp-statistics/	2025-26	Primary not seen; downloads are not production use
~200,000	JPMorgan employees onboarded to LLM Suite	Bloomberg via American Banker	https://www.americanbanker.com/news/how-jpmorganchase-democratized-employee-access-to-gen-ai	2025	Company figure via press; ~half active daily
3B+ / ~50M	Erica cumulative client interactions / users since 2018	Bank of America press release	https://newsroom.bankofamerica.com/content/newsroom/press-releases/2025/08/a-decade-of-ai-innovation--bofa-s-virtual-assistant-erica-surpas.html	20 Aug 2025	Company-reported, cumulative
~46,000	Goldman staff given GS AI Assistant (after 10,000 pilot)	Goldman via press	https://www.americanbanker.com/news/goldman-sachs-staff-now-write-a-million-gen-ai-prompts-a-month	24 Jun 2025	Company figure via press
+70% / +40%	Walmart Sparky users YoY / spend per order of Sparky users	Walmart Q2 FY27 call via CIO Dive	https://www.ciodive.com/news/walmart-AI-wins-sparky-john-furner/812606/	Aug 2026	Company-reported; correlation, not causal; Feb 2026 figure was 35%

Figure	What it measures	Source	URL	Date	Reliability note
82.9%	Organisations with AI projects delayed by security/ compliance review	Protegrity / EMA	https://securitybrief.co.uk/story/enterprise-ai-deployments-slowed-by-security-reviews	Jul 2026	Vendor-sponsored; n not seen
~30%	Of delayed projects, share stalled 4+ months	Protegrity / EMA	same	Jul 2026	As above
~25% (~3 hrs/ week)	Reduction in email time from Copilot; no change in meeting time	Dillon et al., NBER WP 33795, RCT, 66 firms, 7,137 workers	https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w33795/w33795.pdf	2025	Randomised; Microsoft-affiliated authors; search extract
21% to 75%	Weekly Copilot use among treated workers, range across firms	Dillon et al.	same	2025	Randomised access, so variation is organisational
14-15% (34% novices)	Resolutions per hour from AI assistant, customer support	Brynjolfsson, Li, Raymond, QJE 2025 (n=5,172)	https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w31161/w31161.pdf	2025	Peer-reviewed quasi-experiment
26 min/ day	Self-reported time saved, UK cross-government Copilot experiment (20,000 staff)	GDS findings report	https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/microsoft-365-copilot-experiment-cross-government-findings-report/microsoft-365-copilot-experiment-cross-government-findings-report-html	Jun 2025	Self-report, not randomised
No evidence of productivity gain	DBT Copilot pilot (~1,000 licences)	UK DBT via The Register	https://www.theregister.com/2025/09/04/m365_copilot_uk_government	Sep 2025	Government evaluation; primary not seen
7,600+ / 1 in 3 daily	Australian public servants in Copilot trial / share using daily	DTA, Nous Group evaluation	https://www.digital.gov.au/initiatives/copilot-trial/summary-evaluation-findings/cts-executive-summary	Oct 2024	Non-random sample
122%-408%	Projected ROI range, Teams with M365 Copilot	Forrester TEI commissioned by Microsoft	https://tei.forrester.com/go/Microsoft/TeamsandCopilot/	2025	OPINION: vendor-commissioned projection on a composite org

Verbatim quotes

None. Page fetching was blocked for every host tried this session, so no wording could be confirmed against a fetched page. Search-result snippets contained candidate quotes (for example Satya Nadella on 30 million paid Copilot seats, and Gartner's Anushree Verma on hype-driven agentic experiments). Under the brief's rules these are paraphrased above, not quoted. Re-fetch the Gartner press release and the Microsoft FY26 Q4 transcript to capture them verbatim.

Sources worth reading in full

1. MIT NANDA, "The GenAI Divide" PDF (https://mlq.ai/media/quarterly_decks/v0.1_State_of_AI_in_Business_2025_Report.pdf): the most cited and most misread source. Read the methodology page and funnel chart before using "95%".
2. McKinsey, "The state of AI in 2026: On the road to ROI" (PDF above): the largest repeated survey, with year-on-year agent-scaling and EBIT data.
3. RAND RRA2680-1 (https://www.rand.org/pubs/research_reports/RRA2680-1.html): the only qualitative, non-vendor study of root causes. The closest evidence on "can't describe the problem".

4. Gartner, 25 June 2025 press release: the source of the 40%, 130-vendor and agent-washing claims. Read it to see how thin the basis is.
5. Lenovo CIO Playbook 2025 vs 2026 (Business Wire links above): the same sponsor shows conversion moving from 12% to 46%, a useful case study in survey instability.
6. Wharton/GBK "Accountable Acceleration" (https://knowledge.wharton.upenn.edu/special-report/2025-ai-adoption-report): the strongest large-sample counterweight to the failure narrative.
7. Futuriom critique of MIT NANDA (https://www.futuriom.com/articles/news/why-we-dont-believe-mit-nandas-werid-ai-study/2025/08): a concise statement of the methodological objections.
8. ServiceNow Q3 2026 8-K (SEC link above): filing-grade figures on enterprise AI bookings.
9. Dillon, Jaffe, Immorlica and Stanton, NBER WP 33795 (https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w33795/w33795.pdf): the largest randomised enterprise trial of a GenAI assistant; shows reallocation of time and large firm-to-firm variation in use.
10. UK GDS Copilot experiment findings report (https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/683db42bd23a62e5d32680d0/M365_Copilot_Experiment_Findings_Report.pdf) read alongside the DBT evaluation coverage (https://www.theregister.com/2025/09/04/m365_copilot_uk_government): same product, same government, different conclusions.
11. Spider 2.0 (https://arxiv.org/abs/2411.07763): the clearest measurement of how much harder real enterprise data is than benchmark data.
12. Invariant Labs, GitHub MCP vulnerability (https://invariantlabs.ai/blog/mcp-github-vulnerability): the clearest explanation of why connecting agents to shared business context creates an unpatchable class of risk.
13. Australian DTA Copilot evaluation (https://www.digital.gov.au/initiatives/copilot-trial/summary-evaluation-findings/cts-executive-summary): a public-sector evaluation that states its own methodological limits.